

Logan Pearce

ELT Postdoctoral Fellow | University of Michigan

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EDUCATION

University of Arizona <i>PhD in Astronomy</i>	Aug 2019 -- Aug 2024 Tucson, AZ
University of Texas at Austin <i>BS in Astronomy (Honors); BS in Physics</i>	Aug 2015 -- May 2019 Austin, TX
University of Texas at Austin <i>MA in Education</i>	Jun 2012 -- Aug 2014 Austin, TX
Navy Nuclear Training Command <i>Reactor plant operations & theory</i>	Mar 2005 -- Mar 2006 Charleston, SC & Ballston Spa, NY
Purdue University <i>BS in Chemistry</i>	Aug 1999 -- Jun 2003 W. Lafayette, IN

WORK EXPERIENCE

Grand Canyon Conservancy <i>Astronomer in Residence</i>	May -- Jul 2026 Grand Canyon National Park
• Gave 22 public talks + constellation tours • Hosted two full-moon gathering events • Hosted two Astronomy on Tap events • Gave six interactive visitor programs • Gave one interview to Star Stuff Podcast • Co-hosted a livestream for moon landing anniversary through Lowell Obs.	
University of Michigan <i>ELT Postdoctoral Fellow</i>	Aug 2024 -- Present Ann Arbor, MI
• Advised two undergraduate student research projects • Won one (out of two) JWST proposals as PI • Advised team that relaunched Ann Arbor Astronomy on Tap satellite	
University of Arizona Steward Observatory <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i>	Aug 2019 -- Aug 2024 Tucson, AZ
• NSF GRFP fellow • NSF GRFP INTERN program supplemental funding recipient • Assisted ~20 students with NSF GRFP application preparation as a consultant with the UA GRFP Application Development Program • Taught exoplanet-based research projects to student veteran cohorts as part of the Warrior Scholar Project in summer 2020, 2021, and 2022 • Taught workshops and consulted on application materials for ~25 student veterans applying to graduate school via the Diana Davis Spencer Scholars program • Served as lead organizer in relaunch of Tucson Astronomy on Tap satellite after COVID lockdown	
University of Texas at Austin <i>UG Research Assistant + Lab Tech + Writing Center Consultant</i>	Aug 2015 -- May 2019 Austin, TX

- Assisted >250 students on any piece of writing at any stage as a University Writing Center Consultant for 3 semesters
- Assisted in all aspects of fabrication and testing of the VIRUS spectroscopic instrument for the Hobby Eberly Telescope Dark Energy Experiment for 2 semesters

Kealing Middle School

Teacher, Physics & Engineering

Aug 2009 -- May 2015

Austin, TX

- Created and implemented accelerated physics curriculum for 6th grade
- Developed and implemented two engineering elective courses on flight and space exploration
- Lead a team of ~20 teachers as 6th grade team leader, 2013-2015

US Navy

Officer, Nuclear Power Specialty

May 2003 -- May 2008

Jacksonville, FL & Bremerton, WA

- Managed all aspects of reactor plant operations as reactor Propulsion Plant Watch Officer in both at-sea wartime and maintenance conditions
- Managed a team of 30 mechanics maintaining potentially-contaminated reactor plant systems as Mechanical Maintenance Division Officer (2006 -- 2008)
- Managed a team of 10 electronics technicians as Combat Electronics Division Officer (2003 -- 2005)
- Managed all aspects of bridge and combat center operations as Bridge and Combat Center Watch Officer

Publications (Refereed)

FIRST AUTHOR

- **Pearce, L. A.**, Limbach, M., Males, J. R. (2025) *Direct Detection of Known Exoplanets in Reflected Light: Predicting Sky Position with Literature Orbit Solutions*, *PASP*, 137, 094401, doi: 10.1088/1538-3873/ae015e
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Males, J. R., Haffert, S. Y., Close, L. M., Long, J. D., et al. (2025) *Five New Sirius-Like Systems with MagAO-X*, *AJ*, 170, 58P, doi: 10.3847/1538-3881/adbb50
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Limbach, M. A., et al. (2025) *We can directly image super-Earth-sized planets near the habitable zone of Sirius B with JWST/MIRI*, JWST Program. Cycle 4, ID. #7612
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Males, J. R., Haffert, S. Y., Close, L. M., Long, J. D., et al. (2023) *HIP 67506 C: MagAO-X confirmation of a new low-mass stellar companion to HIP 67506 A* *MNRAS* 521, 4775, doi: 10.1093/mnras/stad859
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Males, J. R., Weinberger, A. J., Long, J. D., Morzinski, K. M., et al. (2022) *Companion mass limits for 17 binary systems obtained with binary differential imaging and MagAO/Clio* *MNRAS* 515, 4487
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Kraus, A. L., Dupuy, T. J., Mann, A. W., Huber, D. (2021) *Boyajian's Star B: The Co-moving Companion to KIC 8462852 A* *ApJ* 909, 216
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Kraus, A. L., Dupuy, T. J., Mann, A. W., Newton, E. R., et al. (2020) *Orbital Parameter Determination for Wide Stellar Binary Systems in the Age of Gaia* *ApJ* 894, 115
- **Pearce, L. A.**, Kraus, A. L., Dupuy, T. J., Ireland, M. J., Rizzuto, A. C., et al. (2019) *Orbital Motion of the Wide Planetary-mass Companion GSC 6214-210 b: No Evidence for Dynamical Scattering* *ApJ* 157, 71

CONTRIBUTING AUTHOR

(Selected)

- Venner, A., **Pearce, L.**, An, Q. et al. (2026) *A New Sirius-like System at Only 21 Parsecs: An Elusive White Dwarf Companion to the Nearby K-dwarf HD 38230* *Submitted to AAS Journals*, 536, 1
- Venner, A., Limbach, M., Mâlin, M., Blouin, S., Boccaletti A., & **Pearce, L.** (2025) *Serendipitous observation of a white dwarf companion to a JWST/MIRI coronagraphic calibrator* *MNRAS*, 536, 1
- Barber M. G., Mann, A. W., et al. (**Pearce, L. A.**, 7 of 35) (2024) *A giant planet transiting a 3-Myr protostar with a misaligned disk* *Nature* 635, 8039
- Long, J. D., Males, J. R., Haffert, S. Y., **Pearce, L.**, et al. (2023) *Improved Companion Mass Limits for Sirius A with Thermal Infrared Coronagraphy Using a Vector-apodizing Phase Plate and Time-domain Starlight-subtraction Techniques* *AJ*, 165, 5
- Dupuy, T. J., Liu, M. C., Evans, E. L., Best, W. M. J., **Pearce, L. A.**, et al. (2023) *On the masses, age, and architecture of the VHS J1256-1257AB b system* *MNRAS* 519, 1688
- Venner, A., **Pearce, L. A.**, Vanderburg, A. (2022) *An edge-on orbit for the eccentric long-period planet HR 5183 b* *MNRAS* 516, 3431

- Christian, S., Vanderburg, A., Becker, J., Yahalomi, D. A., **Pearce, L.**, et al. (2022) *A Possible Alignment Between the Orbits of Planetary Systems and their Visual Binary Companions* **AJ 163**, 207
- Venner, A., Vanderburg, A., **Pearce, L. A.** (2021) *True Masses of the Long-period Companions to HD 92987 and HD 221420 from Hipparcos-Gaia Astrometry* **AJ 162**, 12
- Czech, D., Isaacson, H., **Pearce, L.**, Cox, T., Sheikh, S. Z., et al. (2021) *The Breakthrough Listen Search for Intelligent Life: MeerKAT Target Selection* **PASP 133**, 064502
- Newton, E. R., Mann, A. W., Tofflemire, B. M., **Pearce, L. A.**, Rizzuto, A. C., et al. (2019) *TESS Hunt for Young and Maturing Exoplanets (THYME): A Planet in the 45 Myr Tucana-Horologium Association* **ApJ 880**, L17

Presentations (Selected)

Invited Talks

- Colloquium, Wayne State University, 2026
- CEHW Seminar Penn State, 2025
- Frank Bash Symposium, UT Austin, 2025
- IFA Exoplanets Lunch Seminar Univ of Hawai'i, 2023
- Exoplanets Seminar Univ of Cali. Berkeley, 2023
- Lab for Adaptive Optics Seminar Univ of Cali. Santa Cruz, 2023
- APS Lunch Seminar Univ of Colorado, 2022
- Gemini Observatory North, Hilo HI, 2019

Contributed Talks

- Preparing for Gaia Exoplanet Bonanza, Schloss Ringberg, Germany, 2026
- Magellan Science Meeting, Carnegie Inst., Apr 2025
- Other Worlds Laboratory, Santa Cruz CA, Jul 2023
- Bay Area Exoplanets Meeting, Mountain View CA, Apr 2023
- Alien Earths All Hands Meeting, Tucson AZ, Feb 2023
- Steward Observatory Internal Symposium, Nov 2022

Outreach Talks

- 22+ outreach talks, GCC Astr. in Residence, GCNP, May - July 2026
- Veteran Status as a DEI Identity, UM Astro Equi-Tea, Feb 2025
- Student Veterans of America National Convention, Orlando FL, 2022
- Astronomy on Tap Tucson, Dec 2021. Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y-04uo6zsGE>
- Astronomy on Tap ATX, May 2019. Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KAZRro0Qd7Y&t=291s>
- Univ of Texas Astronomy Board of Visitors Winter Meeting, Feb 2019

Selected Posters

- Spirit of Lyot, Pasadena CA, 2026
- GMT Science Meeting, Washington DC, 2023
- Astrobiology Graduate Student Conference, San Diego, 2023
- Spirit of Lyot, Leiden Netherlands, 2022
- AAS Division of Dynamical Astronomy, virtual, 2021
- Exoplanets III, virtual, 2020
- 233rd American Astronomical Society Meeting, Seattle, WA, 2019

Workshops

- Various, Diana Davis Spencer Scholars, Warrior Scholar Project, 2022-2023
- Research Project Leader, Warrior Scholar Project, 24 July - 29 July 2022
- PhD and Grad School Basics, SVRN (virtual), June 2022
- Resume/CV Workshop, UA VETS Center, Jan 2022
- Graduate School Application, UA VETS Center, Fall 2021
- Research Project Leader, Warrior Scholar Project, 25 July - 30 July 2021
- Research Project Leader, Warrior Scholar Project, 21 June - 26 June 2020

Observing Time Awarded as PI

- JWST GO 7612: 30 hours
- MagAO-X: 66 hours
- Gemini/NIFS: 2 hours

Awards and Fellowships

Postdoctoral

- Grand Canyon Astronomer In Residence, 2026
- DEI Certificate; UMich Office of DEI, 2025

Graduate

- Graduate Service Award, Steward Observatory, 2024
- NSF GRFP INTERN Supplemental Funding, to NASA Ames, 2023
- Graduate Research Fellowship, National Science Foundation, 2019

Undergraduate

- Dean's Honored Graduate, Univ of Texas College of Natural Sciences, 2019
- George Mitchell Award, Univ of Texas Co-op, 2019
- Ralph Cutler Green Endowed Scholarship, McDonald Observatory Board of Visitors, 2019
- Barry Goldwater Scholar, Barry Goldwater Scholarship and Excellence in Education Foundation, 2018
- Astronaut Scholar, Astronaut Scholarship Foundation, 2019

Other

- Teacher of Promise, Kealing MS, 2009
- US Navy Commendation Medal, USS John C. Stennis (CVN-74), 2008

References

Dr. Mary Anne Limbach	Univ of Michigan (mlimbach@umich.edu)
Dr. Jared Males	Steward Observatory, Univ of Arizona (jrmale@email.arizona.edu)
Dr. Natasha Batalha	NASA Ames (natasha.e.batalha@nasa.gov)
Dr. Alycia Weinberger	Carnegie EPL (aweinberger@carnegiescience.edu)
Dr. Adam Kraus	University of Texas at Austin (alk@astro.as.utexas.edu)